

Announcement FPP Guest Lecture

Date : Tuesday March 24th, 2026

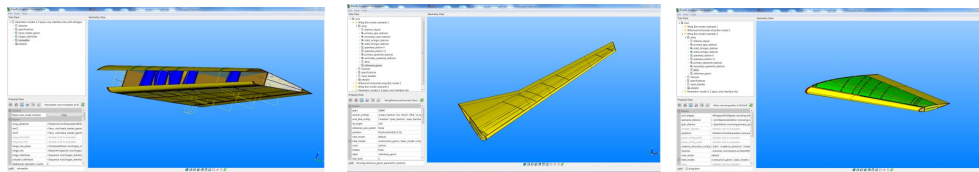
Time : 13:45-14:30h

Location: Lecture room E – Faculty of Aerospace Engineering, Kluyverweg 1, (building 62), Delft

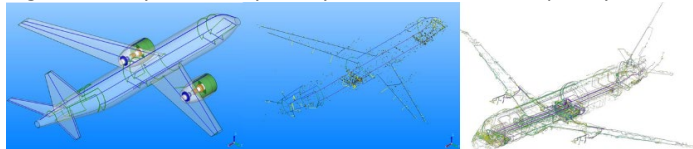
Application of Knowledge Based Engineering (KBE) at GKN Fokker

by **dr.ir. Ton van der Laan, ir. Jente Sonneveld, ir. Thomas Le Montagner - GKN Fokker,**

GKN Fokker is taking steps towards a more digitalized and automated product development process. KBE methodologies are used at Fokker for more than two decades to eliminate repetitive steps from the development process: many aircraft types today fly with components which design was supported by KBE applications for configuration and structural analysis. To remain competitive Tier 1 suppliers like GKN Fokker need to have the ability to respond more rapidly to new market opportunities including electrical, hydrogen and Urban Aerial Mobility (UAM) platforms, whilst applying innovative technologies in the offered solutions to lower the recurring cost. This is to be achieved through digitalization and the application of KBE and Multidisciplinary Design Optimization (MDO) in the development process.



Wings and moveables generated by the ParaPy KBE system based MultiDisciplinary Modelers (MDM) application



Wiring designs generated with EWIS KBE Applications

In this guest lecture, examples from both structural design and electrical wiring design processes will be shown, including a live demo of the MDM KBE application. The technologies used will be addressed as well as the main challenges. There will be opportunities to show also some code and discuss good practices and challenges related to code (co-)development.

GKN Fokker is part of GKN Aerospace: a major tier one supplier at the forefront of aerospace technology and leading global specialist in the design and manufacture of integrated aircraft structures, electrical systems and landing gear. GKN Aerospace offers a full range of metal, composite and additive manufacturing, assembly, systems and through-life aircraft support systems capabilities. TU Delft and GKN Fokker collaborate in various research projects to apply KBE and MDO technologies to industrial cases.

Ton van der Laan is manager Centre of Competence Design at GKN Fokker. He studied Aerospace engineering at Delft University of Technology, the Netherlands where he received his MSc and PhD title.

Thomas Le Montagner is an EWIS KBE specialist at GKN Fokker. He studied Aerospace Engineering at ISAE-SUPAERO at Toulouse, France, where he received his MSc.

Jente Sonneveld is an EWIS KBE specialist at GKN Fokker. He studied Aerospace Engineering at Delft University of Technology, the Netherlands where he received his MSc on a thesis project carried at GKN Fokker.

It is my great pleasure to welcome back at the Faculty our alumni and partners in innovation.

Dr.ir. Gianfranco La Rocca (g.larocca@tudelft.nl), Flight Performance and Propulsion.